

Open a terminal and run the following command:

```
$ apt-get install vim-full.
```

Time to get started now. Open a terminal and type the command given below:

```
$ vim
```

You'll see something similar to the screenshot in Figure 1.

To open or create a new file, type...

```
$ vim filepath
```

Vim opens in the command mode where it accepts Vim commands only. To edit the text, press 'i' to switch to *Insert* mode. Now you can type text. The cursor can be moved using standard keyboard arrows or using the keys given in Figure 2.

To exit from the Vim editing mode, press ESC. Now, to save the changes to the file, type `:w`; to save and quit, type `:wq`; and to quit without saving changes, type `:q!`.

Let's now look at some of the important operating modes of Vim.

Command mode: We can use different letters or letter sequences to command Vim operations. Vim commands are case sensitive. The ESC keystroke can terminate the command.

Insert mode: When the editor is in *Insert* mode, on the footer part you will see the '-- INSERT --' status. To switch back to command mode, press ESC. Text can be inserted in this mode. Press 'i' to initiate *Insert* mode. It is possible to initiate *Insert* at different portions of the text. To insert at the next new line, press 'o'; to insert at the new line before the current one, press 'O'; and to insert at the end of the line, press 'A'.

Command line mode: In command line mode, we use commands starting with ':' which will show commands that we're typing at the moment, at the footer part of the editor. For example, `:help`, `:wq`, etc.

Basic operations

To open and save files

To open files with Vim, use the following command: `vim file`. To open multiple files as split windows, type: `$ vim -O file1 file2`. To open a file from the Vim command-line, use the following: `:e file` // Auto complete is supported by pressing TAB.

To save the changes to the currently opened file, press ESC to switch to the command mode from the editing mode, then type `:w` and press ENTER. To exit Vim after saving a file, type `:wq`. To just quit without saving, use `:q!`. To save the current file as a new file, use the command line `:w new_filepath`.

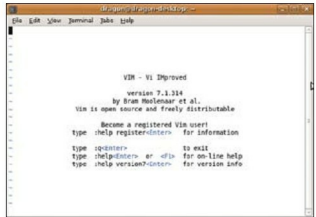


Figure 1: The Vim editor



Figure 2: Cursor navigation

Manipulating files

Cut, copy and *paste* are essential features of any text editor. To cut the current word, place the cursor at the starting character of the word and use 'cw'. To cut the current line, use 'cc' in the command mode. To copy the current word, place the cursor at the starting letter and use 'yw', while to copy an entire line, use 'yy'. To paste content, place the cursor at the position where the contents of the buffer need to be placed, and press 'p'.

To remove a word, place the cursor at the starting letter of the word, and press 'dw', while to remove a line, press 'dd', and to remove a character, press 'x'. To undo the previous action, press 'u', while to redo an action, 'Ctrl + r'. To repeat a previously performed task, press ':' To list the available *undo tasks*, 'undolist'.

To search, substitute and replace

To search for a word/sentence while in the command mode, type `/word` and press ENTER, where 'word' is the word you're searching for. To repeat the search in the forward direction, press `n`, while to reverse the direction of the search, press `?`.

To replace a part of the text, use:

- `:%s/word_pattern/replacement_text/` - replaces